CSS Times

Daily Current Affiars 06 Aug

1. Uproar as Pakistan excluded from UK travel list

• The British government`s latest quarantine traffic light system update has come under heavy criticism by British MPs and citizens, with some saying the decision to keep Pakistan on the red list when other countries have been removed is `political` and not led by scientific data.
• `I am surprised that India has moved to the amber list, whilst Pakistan remains on the red list.
• It is not the first time that this government has shown such callous behaviour when dealing with the quarantine traffic light system, said Labour MP Naz Shah in a statement after the announcement

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2. RDA inflow reaches $1.87bn

• The inflow through Roshan Digital Account reached $1.87 billion at the end of July, with the first month of the current fiscal year witnessing the second highest inflow since the RDA was launched in September last year.
• Data released by the State Bank of Pakistan (SBP) on August 5, 2021 shows that the country received $307 million in July compared to $310m in June, reflecting a trend with inflow of over $300m per month.
• The RDA was introduced by the SBP in September 2020 for non-resident Pakistanis to enable them to remotely open bank accounts in Pakistan through online digital portals without physically visiting branches.

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3. Two soldiers martyred in separate attacks

• Two security personnel were martyred and four others, including an officer, injured in gun and bomb attacks in Khyber and South Waziristan tribal districts on August 5, 2021.
• Officials said the two soldiers of Frontier Constabulary martyred by some unidentified gunmen in Tirah valley of Khyber district.
• Police in Bara said the two members of Khalil-Mohmand Platoon, who were posted at Durbi Khel Ziyarat hillock overlooking parts of Tirah valley both on Khyber and Orakzai sides, went to a nearby spring to fetch water

for their trench when the gunmen opened fire, killing both on the spot

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4. Akbar Ayub de-notified as KP local govt minister after resignation

• The Khyber Pakhtunkhwa government on August 5, 2021 de-notified Akbar Ayub Khan as the minister for local government and rural development following his resignation.
• The development comes more than a week after the sacking of a minister and an adviser to the chief minister.
• A notification issued by the administration department read, `the governor KP in the exercise of powers conferred under Clause 3 of Article 132 of the Constitution read with Clause 1 of Article 105 thereof is pleased to de-notify Mr Akbar Ayub Khan, minister for LG&RD and human rights and parliamentary affairs portfolios. On de-notification from his respective office, he has ceased to hold the portfolio of the provincial minister with an immediate effect

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5. Russia boosts arms supplies to

Central Asia amid Afghan mayhem

• Russia has increased arms and military hardware supplies to Uzbekistan and Tajikistan amid fighting in Afghanistan, Interfax news agency quoted Russian military chief of staff Valery Gerasimov as saying on August 5, 2021.
• Gerasimov, who was in Tashkent to attend joint Uzbek-Russian military drills near the Afghan border, provided no details such as what arms were being supplied.
• Russia is also carrying out drills in Tajikistan, another former Soviet republic bordering Afghanistan, this week. For the Uzbek exercise, Moscow said on Thursday it would even deploy four strategic bombers

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6. Dostum back in Afghanistan, to fight for besieged home

• Infamous warlord Abdul Rashid Dostum has returned to Afghanistan as the Taliban inch closer to taking control of his longtime stronghold in the north and fight for control of a string of cities elsewhere.
• Ehsan Nero, a spokesman for the former army paratrooper, said that

Dostum arrived in Kabul on August 4, 2021 night and was meeting senior officials to talk about security in Sheberghan, capital of Jawzjan province.
• The former vice president has been in Turkey for months, where he was believed to be receiving medical treatment.
• `He is waiting to meet President Ashraf Ghani,` Nero said.

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7. India flexes muscles with new aircraft carrier, task force

• India is flexing its maritime muscles to counter growing Chinese influence, conducting sea trials on its First indigenous aircraft carrier and dispatching a task force for joint exercises with the United States and other allies.
• The INS Vikrant, which began trials off the southern state of Kerala, will be India`s second aircraft carrier in operation.
• The Indian Navy said the country can now `join a select group of nations with the capability to indigenously design and build an Aircraft Carrier, which will be a real testimony to the `Make in India` thrust of the Indian Government.` The new 262-metre (860-foot) carrier joins the INS Vikramaditya, the Soviet-made Admiral

Gorshkov that India bought in 2004.

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8. Biden allows HK citizens to stay in US for 18 months

- President Joe Biden announced on August 5, 2021 that Hong Kong citizens currently in the United States who fear for their safety amid the political crackdown back home will receive temporary safe haven.
- Biden said the move recognises `the significant erosion` of rights and freedoms in Hong Kong by the Chinese government.
- `By unilaterally imposing on Hong Kong the Law of the People`s Republic of China on Safeguarding National Security in the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region, the People`s Republic of China has undermined the enjoyment of rights and freedoms in Hong Kong,` he said in a statement

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9. Major nations ignore WHO call to stop booster plans

• Germany, France and Israel will go ahead with plans to administer Covid-19 vaccine boosters, disregarding an appeal by the World Health Organisation to hold off until more people are vaccinated around the world.
• The decision to press ahead with booster shots despite the WHO`s strongest statement yet highlights the huge inequities in responses to the pandemic as richer nations ramp up programmes to protect citizens from the more infectious Delta variant.
• French President Emmanuel Macron said France was working on rolling out third doses to the elderly and vulnerable from September

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10. New Zealand to tour Pakistan after 18 years

• New Zealand will tour Pakistan for the first time in 18 years to play three One-day Internationals and five Twenty 20 Internationals, cricket boards of both countries said on August 5, 2021.
• Pakistan has made steady strides in restoring its image as a safe venue for international matches, after successfully hosting Zimbabwe, Sri Lanka, the West Indies, and South Africa in recent years.
• The Pakistan Cricket Board (PCB) said New Zealand will tour Pakistan for the first time since 2003 starting from Sept

17, with all matches split between Rawalpindi and Lahore